Working Investigation

Checkpoint: November 12, 2026, by 11:59 PM Mountain Time
Team: [Names]
Route: [A / B / C]
Date: [Date]

Use the prompts for your chosen route to describe what is working now and what you learned from a first check. Add a new, dated entry for the working investigation to the root `README.md` of your team's GitHub repository and link the relevant code and output there. Keep earlier entries, commit the update, and submit the repository URL with that commit in Canvas. This file is optional supporting material; it does not replace the README entry. Preliminary or negative results are welcome when you explain what they show.

Working code and evidence

- What part of your investigation runs now? Link the code, configuration, and an output it produced.
- What inputs and steps does the run use? Give the command to reproduce the first check if available, and note any data access or setup needed.
- What comparison or diagnostic did you run, using which evaluation split, metric, or quality measure? What does the result show so far?

Route-specific progress

Complete the prompts for your chosen route.

Route A: New method or system component

- What team-designed component is implemented, and where is it in the code?
- Does it behave as intended on a small example or check? Link the result.
- How does its first result compare with the reference method under comparable conditions? What setting or error should you investigate next?

Route B: Kaggle competition

- Where is the working path from raw competition data through preparation, local validation, training, and inference to a submission file? Link the code and record the run command or configuration.
- What was the local validation result, and why is that validation appropriate for the competition?
- Link the first **valid Kaggle submission** and record its Kaggle result. Which pipeline and commit produced the submission file? What will you change or test for the second pipeline?

Route C: New dataset and ML pipeline

- Where are the collection, cleaning, and integration scripts that produce the cleaned dataset? Give the run order and record the source dates or versions and any access limits.
- What does one cleaned observation represent? Link a permissible sample or summary and report relevant quality checks, such as coverage, duplicates, missingness, or label consistency.
- What initial ML result did you obtain **using the cleaned output of this pipeline**? Link its code and output. What do the quality checks and ML result suggest you should investigate next?

Next question

- If your plan changed since November 5, what evidence or feedback led to the change?
- What is uncertain or blocked now, and how will you adjust the scope if needed?